MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, with the last two focused mainly on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams supporting approximately 25 developers. Build automated deployment workflows with Docker, Helm and Kubernetes, complemented by personal infrastructure-as-code and GitOps projects. Seeking to move into DevOps / platform engineering full time.

SKILLS

CI/CD and deployment: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm; Kubernetes application deployments with namespace-level access.

Infrastructure as code and GitOps: Terraform for a personal Hetzner VPS; Argo CD and k3s in a personal homelab; basic Ansible.

Observability: Grafana dashboards for CI and test metrics; Prometheus and Loki in a personal homelab.

Systems and scripting: Linux, Git, Python, Bash, PostgreSQL, SQL; Java for test automation.

Cloud and TLS: AWS EC2 and S3 basics through personal learning; Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS in a personal homelab.

Test automation: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021 - Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end tests, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and separate end-to-end execution; monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Built per-merge-request ephemeral environments, initially with Docker Compose and later with Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster managed by the platform team.
- Automated deployment of the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data from GitLab CI, with environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintained approximately 900 pytest and Playwright tests; built PostgreSQL-backed Grafana dashboards to identify flaky tests, helping reduce the flaky rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test data seeding and the internal CI documentation used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019 - 2021

- Tested web and mobile applications across client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018 - 2019

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

PERSONAL INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | 2024 - 2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with all applications deployed from a Git repository through Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used basic Ansible.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027.

LANGUAGES

Polish: native | English: C1 | German: A2